

Recommendation letter checklist

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Documents to Send

Send **one email**, at least **a month before your first deadline**, with the subject line “Recommendation letter: *your name*”. Include:

- ☐ A photo (I may not remember your name in two years)
- ☐ Which of my courses you took, and when
- ☐ Your final grade in each
- ☐ CV
- ☐ Unofficial transcript
- ☐ (Draft) statement of purpose
- ☐ Any other work related to the program or to my courses
- ☐ **What you’d like me to highlight** (see below)
- ☐ **PhD applicants only:** a Google Sheet or Excel file listing each program, its deadline, how it collects letters, and a column for me to check off.

What to highlight. Do not be modest or shy. Be clear, upfront and **advocate for yourself**; err on the side of claiming too much. I will use this as starting material for my letter. If I do not agree with anything you say, I’ll simply leave it out, so you should not feel uncomfortable about blowing your own trumpet. But if you do not remind me of something important, I might fail to add it to the letter.

What Happens Next

1. Once I have everything, I’ll let you know and start on your letter.
2. About a week before each deadline, email me a reminder with the subject line “Recommendation letter reminder: *your name*, due *date*”.